Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
48121
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan

July 2, 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S14 Supplement #1:
1. Incorrect VINs Entered In Affected Vehicle List
2. Return of Fuel Tank Cut Sections on Cracked Fuel Tanks
3. Revised Ordering Instructions for Replacement Fuel Tanks (Effective October 1, 2001)

REFERENCE: Safety Recall 01S14: Certain 1997 through 2001 Model Year E-150 Wagons, E-350 Wagons, and E-350 Ambulance Prep Package Vans, Equipped With 35 Gallon Mid-Ship Gasoline and Diesel Fuel Tanks – Fuel Tank Insulator Installation

REASON FOR THIS SUPPLEMENT:

1. On the vehicles involved in this program, the 35-gallon gasoline and diesel mid-ship fuel tanks are the **only** fuel tanks affected. However, some vehicles equipped with NGV fuel systems and vehicles with 55 gallon fuel tanks were erroneously loaded into OASIS and the owners of these vehicles were sent letters.
2. Parts Update: Effective October 1, 2001, a revised cracked fuel tank replacement procedure will be in effect.

ACTION:

All erroneous VINs entered into OASIS have been identified and removed from OASIS. A letter of apology will be sent to each of those owners.

Effective October 1, 2001, follow normal ordering procedures for replacement of cracked fuel tanks. Also, effective October 1, 2001, return of cracked fuel tank sections will no longer be required. (See revised Attachment II)

AFFECTED VEHICLES

- Certain 1997 through 2001 model year E-150 wagons and E-350 wagons equipped with 35-gallon mid-ship fuel tanks and built at the Lorain Assembly Plant from April 9, 1996 through November 14, 2000.
- Certain 1997 through 2001 model-year E-350 ambulance prep package vans equipped with 35 gallon mid-ship fuel tanks and built at the Lorain Assembly Plant from April 9, 1996 through November 14, 2000.

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SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles a crack may develop on the top of the fuel tank where it contacts the frame cross members. If a crack develops, the exterior of the fuel tank may become wet with fuel. In some cases, fuel may drip on the ground. Fuel leakage in sufficient quantity in the presence of an ignition source could potentially result in a fire.

SERVICE ACTION

At no charge to the customers, dealers will install fuel tank insulators on all affected vehicles. The insulators will be positioned between the top of the fuel tank and the mating surfaces of the two cross members. In rare cases, if the top of the fuel tank is cracked, a new fuel tank will be installed.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter(s)

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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Safety Recall 01S14-S1:
Certain 1997 through 2001 Model Year E-150 Wagons, E-350 Wagons, and E-350 Ambulance Prep Package Vans, Equipped With 35 Gallon Gasoline and Diesel Mid-Ship Fuel Tanks
Fuel Tank Insulator Installation

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs applicable to this recall which were made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

If fuel tank replacement is necessary, Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at the owner's expense. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "LOANER" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the recall claim.

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Safety Recall 01S14-S1:
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Fuel Tank Insulator Installation

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Install fuel tank insulators according to instructions in Attachment III.	01S14B	1.6 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall except for the no-charge F-500 Fuel Neutralizer. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
F65Z-9240-DC	Fuel Tank Insulator	2 required per repair

ORDER INFORMATION

DOR/COR number is 50232. This number identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for “Parts Retention and Return Procedures”.

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Safety Recall 01S14-S1:
Certain 1997 through 2001 Model Year E-150 Wagons, E-350 Wagons, and E-350 Ambulance Prep Package Vans, Equipped With 35 Gallon Mid-Ship Gasoline and Diesel Fuel Tanks
Fuel Tank Insulator Installation

CRACKED FUEL TANK

- THE FOLLOWING FUEL TANK ORDERING AND RETURN INSTRUCTIONS WILL BE IN EFFECT THROUGH SEPTEMBER 30, 2001.

  In the rare case that a fuel tank is cracked, dealers are required to:

  - Call the Recall Hotline for direction (1-800-325-5621)
  - If fuel tank replacement is required, use F-500 to neutralize the fuel in the tank before cutting cracked section (see " F-500 Fuel Neutralizer" below).
  - Cut the cracked section from the fuel tank.
  - To avoid "charge back", return the cut section of the fuel tank directly to:

    Ford Motor Company
    Diagnostic Service Center II, Cube 781
    1800 Fairlane Drive
    Allen Park, Michigan 48101

- EFFECTIVELY IMMEDIATELY: Regarding the return of the fuel tank cut sections; you will NOT be notified via the "Dealer Register". Send cut section directly to the above address.
- BEGINNING OCTOBER 1, 2001, FOLLOW NORMAL ORDERING PROCESS FOR FUEL TANKS.
- ALSO, EFFECTIVE OCTOBER 1, 2001, THE RETURN OF FUEL TANK CUT SECTIONS WILL BE DISCONTINUED AND FUEL NEUTRALIZER KITS WILL NO LONGER BE AVAILABLE.

NOTE: Return only the cut section of the fuel tank. Complete fuel tank assemblies will be refused and returned to the sending dealer.

F-500 FUEL NEUTRALIZER

- At no cost, each dealer will receive one 4 ounce bottle of F-500 Fuel Neutralizer directly from Hazard Control Technologies, Inc. to be used if fuel tank replacement is necessary. (Expect delivery of the F-500 the second week of April 2001. It will be addressed to "ATTN: Service Manager".)
- Before cutting the cracked section from the fuel tank, follow the directions that come with the Fuel Neutralizer or instructions FAXed to you from the Recall Hotline. If more F-500 is needed, call 1-800-325-5621.

NOTE: Fuel Neutralizer may be used for other repairs involving fuel tank replacement.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or updated price book.

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
www.ownerconnection.com

April 2001

01S14

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1997 through 2001 model year E-150 Wagons, E-350 Wagons, and E-350 Ambulance Prep Package Vans, equipped with 35 gallon Gasoline and Diesel mid-ship fuel tanks.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the issue is …

In some of the affected vehicles, a hairline crack may develop on the top of the fuel tank. If a crack develops, the exterior of the fuel tank may become wet with fuel. In some cases, fuel may drip on the ground. Fuel leakage in sufficient quantity in the presence of an ignition source could potentially result in a fire.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). To reduce stress levels in the fuel tank on your vehicle, Ford dealers will install insulators on the fuel tank. In the rare event your vehicle has already developed a fuel tank crack, a new fuel tank will be installed free of charge.

How long will it take?

Fuel tank insulators can be installed in less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time. In the rare case where inspection reveals that a new fuel tank must be installed, your dealer may need to order parts. In this situation, your dealer will require your vehicle for a longer period of time.

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What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 01S14.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. However, If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

Need a rental?…

If a fuel tank replacement is necessary, your dealer is authorized to provide a rental vehicle at no charge (except for fuel) while your vehicle is at the dealership for repairs.

If you've already paid for this service …

If your fuel tank was cracked as previously described and you paid to have the fuel tank replaced before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a refund. To receive the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this recall.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance. If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call (866) 436-7332

Office Hours (Eastern Time Zone)
Monday – Friday: 8AM – 11PM
Saturday: 9AM – 6PM

Hearing impaired call (800) 232-2952
TDD for the hearing impaired.

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

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Quality Care service is there for you all year long.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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